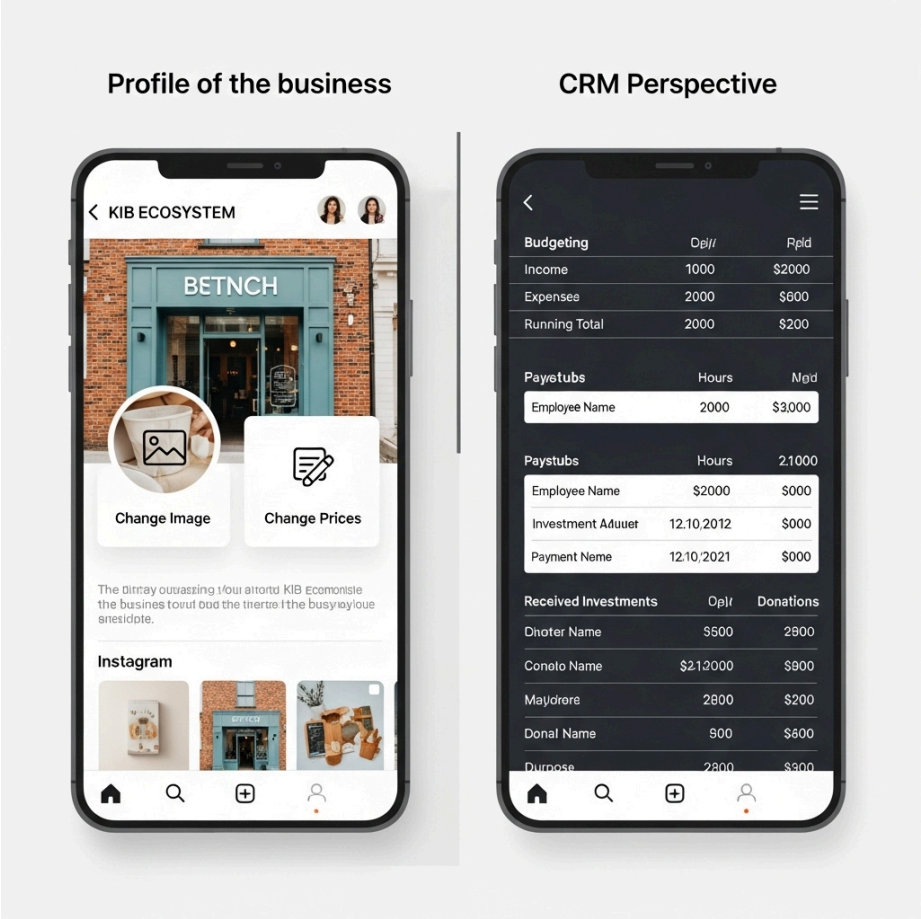
Milhojas ecosystem

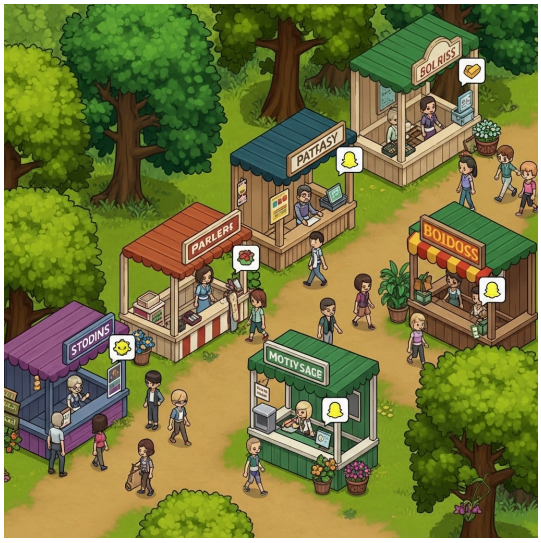
I have been entertaining the idea of support for small vendors and businesses. There are so many existing free access tools for investing, book-keeping, CRM, but there is little for people who have zero formal business development experience. This project/platform is intended to incentivize business creation, help existing small and medium sized businesses and increase visibility of businesses to governments (there is little to no help for “informal” businesses). I think LLMs and AI are at the right stage of development to lower the barrier to entry for independent local businesses to grow using more advanced business development tools and strategies, boosting not only the economy but also self-reliant communities.

It would be a way for small business owners with no coding/marketing/suite programs experience to build a CRM, reach their market more easily, and publicize with marketing tools at their disposal, as easily as using an Instagram profile. For consumers, the ecosystem integrates not only buying products but also investing, work, and direct communication through timed sync events.

1. First Moat / competitive advantage/interest for business owners: It would be the first app/platform to include a minimum CRM structure for small businesses, for simple accounting tasks: simple listing/menu of available products, their price, and images. That keeps track at the end of day of units sold/earnings/profit (including an optional field of cost per product). Monthly budgeting, paystub, fixed costs. Could then integrate an LLM with access to these documents for spoken commands (premium and later version). Could also include an LLM to offer suggestions for help with the legal framework for quick formalization of business or business/marketing strategies (premium and later version).



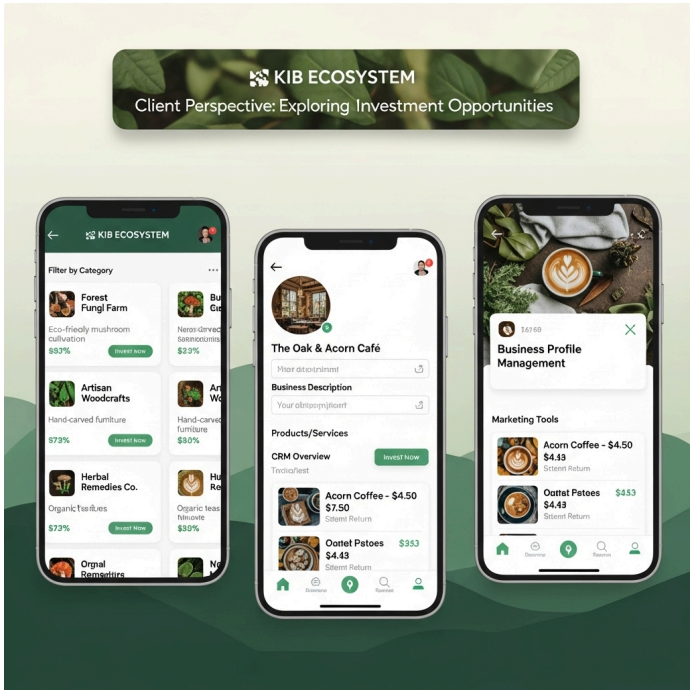
2. First moat / competitive advantage/interest for consumers: First app to integrate a simple environment with simple UX like Netflix, where consumers see what's available for them to eat/buy/request, and scrolling further away shows services/stores further away. Promoting buying/requesting services close to the consumer. A later version can look similar to the game SIMS, where consumers have an avatar and "look around a market" of different stores and services, with monthly "community fairs" with businesses ready to take questions and orders. Instead of just ordering food, you can talk/chat to someone from that business when it is "open". Creating and gamifying a "virtual market". Where other consumers can see other people who were exploring the platform and visiting stores.





(picture of a “digital fair” where users can visit different stands. This can be a more advanced version of the app)

3. Second moat / competitive advantage/interest for business owners: First app to integrate UNIQUE tools such as investment/volunteering/donations: a new type of work/collaboration between people and businesses, where businesses can offer job opportunities, raffles, collabs with other businesses (we can call this “kismet”). This can also be a later stage feature.



Prompt:
Lay out a plan with different phases for rolling out this business idea in different stages, with different maturity levels in its features as it gets progressively validated, including tentative objective marks, for example, having revenue or hitting X number of users. Pay close attention to building a cross-platform solution, at least something where I can manage the business with continuous integration with an Android app. I would like to have an MVP that can update databases (add, sign up, edit, and remove products or business owners) both from an Android app and from a web platform. I would prefer having the minimum to none upfront cost of web hosting or app release, even if that means using domains that include the name of tools such as Vercel. I also want something that can easily scale and integrate auth, db handling, security and continuous integration. I could change platforms to something of higher quality or more expensive once I have passed validation rounds. I can afford a maximum of $100 a month, for up to a year, but again, I would prefer to start very simple and validate my idea throughout the development process. If required, give me two-column tables comparing different options for design decisions for example: sticking to only app mode, or multiplatform from the beginning or using vercel compared to another, or using firebase or another for auth and db management, start free or pricing, start with a freemium version, etc. Report back with an md file containing an elevator pitch, the project plan with phases. Possible early design decisions. Your suggestions for the next steps and expected costs. Short business idea evaluation where you give an honest view of the feasibility of this business being successful: I want to have 40 business owners signed up and at least 60 recurring monthly users by the end of the year. The initial target markets are: 1. San Francisco / bay area. 2. Pereira / Colombia, compare both target markets. Recall that the platform is oriented to small businesses, artisans, entrepreneurs or small no-chain vendors, what are they willing to pay for any or all of the features? After you have finished this md file, you can also create other files that you consider are valuable to orchestrate other AI models to build this platform/app. If known, give me information about other businesses that are doing similar activities as the one I propose, for example whatsapp for businesses, how are thy doing? What is their growth? Look at these repositories for templates of businesses, although we can start a new platform from scratch: https://github.com/mercurjs/mercur, https://github.com/ApiceFlow/flutter-ecommerce-template, https://github.com/HichamxMahboub/marketplace-hub. Keep this project contained, in a folder in local. Give me an estimation of costs and/or development time for each phase, consider that I can be capable of running marketing and publicity up to the goal for the end of the year.

Gemini 2.5:

Of course. Here is a revised MVP cost estimation that removes developer payments and approximates hosting costs using Firebase based on your specified usage scenario.

This estimate assumes that the development work (coding and design) is being completed via "sweat equity" by the founders and is therefore not a cash expense for the MVP phase.

MVP Scenario Assumptions:

- **Users:** 50 businesses and 400 consumer clients.
- **Activity:** Each of the 400 clients sends/receives 3 communications with businesses per day.
- **Content:** Each business has a profile with approximately 10 photos; clients have one profile picture.

Estimated Hosting Costs Using Firebase (Blaze Plan)

For an MVP, the Firebase "Blaze" (Pay-as-you-go) plan is ideal. It includes a generous free tier for all services and you only pay for usage *beyond* that free allowance.

Based on your scenario, here is a breakdown of the estimated monthly costs:

- **Authentication (User Logins):**
    - **Usage:** 450 users.

    - **Free Tier:** 10,000 authentications per month.
    - **Estimated Cost: $0**
- **Firestore Database (for storing profiles, messages, listings):**
    - **Usage:**
        - **Writes:** ~1,200 messages per day + minor profile updates (~37,500 per month).
        - **Reads:** Users browsing profiles and reading messages (~30,000-40,000 reads per day, or ~1.2M per month).
        - **Data Stored:** Text data for all users and businesses will be very low, likely under 1 GB.
    - **Free Tier:** 20,000 writes/day, 50,000 reads/day, and 1 GiB of storage.
    - **Estimated Cost: $0**. Your estimated initial usage comfortably fits within the daily free allowances for database operations.
- **Cloud Storage (for photos and logos):**
    - This is the primary cost driver. The cost comes from data transfer (egress) when users view images.
    - **Usage:**
        - **Data Stored:** ~300-400 MB (well within the 5 GB free tier).
        - **Data Egress (Downloads):** If 400 users browse and view photos daily, this could generate several gigabytes of data transfer. Estimating ~5-10 GB of egress per day is reasonable.
    - **Free Tier:** 1 GB of egress per day.
    - **Calculation:** Assuming 9 GB of paid egress per day at ~$0.12/GB.

Estimated Cost: (9 GB/day * 0.12/GB)∗30days=∗∗ 0.12/GB)∗30days=∗∗

    - 32.40 per month.**
- **Cloud Functions & Hosting:**
    - **Usage:** Any backend functions (like sending a notification) and hosting for a landing page would be minimal for this user load.
    - **Free Tier:** Extremely generous for both services.
    - **Estimated Cost: $0**

Total Estimated Monthly Firebase Cost: ~$35 - $50
(This includes a small buffer for unexpected usage spikes.)

New Estimation of Total MVP Costs (Excluding Development)

These are the essential cash expenses required to get the MVP operational and legally compliant.

One-Time Costs (Upfront Investment):

- **Google Play Developer Account:** $25 (one-time fee).
- **Company Registration/LLC Filing:** $100 - $500 (varies by state/country).
- **Legal Documents:** $500 - $2,500 (for Privacy Policy and Terms of Service templates or a lawyer's review).
- **Initial Marketing & Launch Budget:** $250 - $1,000 (for social media ads or promotions to attract the first 50 businesses).

Total One-Time Costs: ~$875 - $4,025

Recurring Costs:

- **Firebase Hosting:** ~$35 - $50 / month.

Apple Developer Program:
99/year(or 99/year(or

- 8.25 / month).

Domain Name: ~
15/year(or 15/year(or

- 1.25 / month).
- **Business Email (e.g., Google Workspace):** ~$12 / month (for 2 founders).

Total Recurring Costs: ~$56 - $71 / month

By removing developer salaries and leveraging Firebase's cost-effective structure, the initial cash required to launch the KIB ECOSYSTEM MVP becomes significantly lower, focusing primarily on essential administrative, legal, and operational expenses.